DHRUV KOTHARI

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SUMMARY

Full-stack developer building Android apps, Python backends and AI integrations, with tests and CI on personal projects. Two hackathon wins and one finalist place across 2025–2026.

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Information Technology — *K. J. Somaiya College of Engineering, Mumbai* 2024 – 2028 (expected)

EXPERIENCE

Growth Intern — *Blink.new (1Flow Inc., YC W22)* Jan 2026 – Present

- Run answer engine optimisation (AEO): Reddit content structured so ChatGPT and Perplexity recommend Blink.new.
- Grew Reddit-referred traffic to 24% of total site visits in one month; ran creator affiliate outreach.

Web Developer Intern — *ARH Tubes Pvt. Ltd.* Dec 2025 – Jan 2026
Refactored UI and asset handling and integrated backend APIs, improving page load and responsiveness by ∼15%.

PROJECTS

FocusLock — *Kotlin, Android, Electron, Firebase* 2026

- Cross-device screen-time enforcer sharing one daily quota between an Android accessibility service and a Windows agent over Firestore, with deny-by-default security rules.
- Split impression counting from enforcement into framework-free state machines covered by 200+ unit tests; CI builds a signed APK and installer on tag.

BasketProof — *Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Kotlin* 2026

- Grocery basket comparator across Blinkit, Zepto and Instamart that reports a total only when every item price is verified, failing closed on unconfirmed cart writes.
- 600+ tests, Alembic migrations, CI running mypy, ruff and pytest against a real Postgres container.

Expense Tracker — *React Native, Kotlin, TypeScript, SQLite* 2026

- Captures bank SMS and payment notifications into a crash-safe peek/ack buffer while the app is closed, with false-positive guards for OTPs and failed payments.
- Stores data locally in SQLite with versioned migrations; no account, no cloud.

DarkSentinel (**Finalist**, Secure AI Systems & Software Hackathon) — *Python, FastAPI, Next.js* 2026

- In a team darknet-traffic monitor, built LLM escalation only for uncertain Random Forest predictions (0.55–0.75 confidence, 60s cooldown) with gateway to direct-API to heuristic fallback, bounding inference cost.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Kotlin, C++
- **Backend & Web:** FastAPI, Flask, Node.js, Express, React, Next.js, REST APIs, Tailwind CSS
- **Mobile & Desktop:** Android (Kotlin, accessibility services), React Native, Electron
- **Data & Infra:** pandas, scikit-learn, PostgreSQL, Firestore, SQLite, Docker, pytest, GitHub Actions

ACHIEVEMENTS & ACTIVITIES

- **Winner**, Innovathon 2025 — **Winner**, REALMS 2025 — **Finalist**, Secure AI Systems & Software Hackathon 2026
- **Tech Team:** Robotics & Automation Society, KJSCE (Aug 2025–Present); Team Vision KJSCE (Jan–Aug 2025)